

Résumé - Aleksandr “Sasha” Motsjonov

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Full-stack engineer with 20+ years of experience building for the web — TypeScript/JavaScript, Node.js and others — across startups, mid-size companies, and large-scale enterprise. 11 years at Atlassian, 7+ as a Senior IC.

Personal Profile

- Strong architectural thinking: comfortable making high-stakes technical decisions, writing design documents, and defending tradeoffs across teams
- Proven mentor and team multiplier — contributed to multiple engineer promotions, ran book clubs, and onboarded new team members and PMs
- Deep care for end users and product quality; proactive about improving both the systems I build and the processes around them
- Honest and straightforward communicator across engineering, product, and design — equally comfortable pushing back on a technical decision, debugging an incident in a war room, or presenting a demo to 50+ people

General expertise

General programming skills

OOP, FP, Algorithms, Control flows, Data structures, Design Patterns

TypeScript / JavaScript

TypeScript, React, Redux, ES6+, Webpack, Node.js, CoffeeScript, Angular, Backbone, jQuery

Other parts of the Web stack

DOM, CSS3/SASS, HTML5, Canvas, Websocket, other APIs

Architecture & Practices

Microservices, Monorepo tooling, Feature flags / progressive rollout, Graph databases (Cypher), TDD/BDD (Jest, JUnit), SOLID principles, DRY

Backend technologies

NodeJS (ExpressJS and others), Java (Play!, Spring, ORMs), Python (Django), Ruby (RoR)

Infrastructure

AWS, Git, Spinnaker, Bamboo, Jenkins, Docker, VS Code / IntelliJ IDEA, Bash

Achievements

- At Atlassian, I led the development of Smart Link List View — a feature that lets users embed live, configurable tables of Jira issues directly inside Confluence and Jira editors, replacing the legacy Jira Issue Macro. I also drove critical architecture decisions, including a multi-week investigation that prevented a costly merge of two competing table implementations.
- As a **Senior-level IC (P50 for 7+ years)** frequently acting as Tech Lead, I **received “Exceeding Expectations” ratings** in half of my recent performance cycles. I managed teams of 5–8 engineers, mentored three colleagues toward promotions, and represented the Linking Platform in cross-team technical negotiations — including ownership transitions, API decommission pushbacks, and redirecting partner teams toward simpler solutions that saved weeks of development time.
- In earlier years at Atlassian, in the Purchasing department I helped develop a painless purchase experience for our customers. After that, as part of JIRA Service Desk, my team was responsible for tackling most voted issues by our customers. Later I moved to the media team, where I was feature lead on a public links project that allows customers to unfurl thousands of links in Jira, Confluence and Trello.
- I’ve been selected as one of three people from Sydney office to participate in an Artificial Intelligence innovation week that took place in Mountain View.
- As part of the Toggl development team I developed a completely new web experience for our user base of more than 500,000. I modularized our client-side Backbone code in order to increase maintainability and facilitate its reuse. It utilises websockets for instantaneous synchronisation and can also work offline.
- I wrote the web application for Toggl’s hiring campaign as a personal initiative. Every applicant can test his or her knowledge and show their coding skills. I released this code as an [open source](#) project.
- While working at Swedbank I replaced their dated Flash-based stock chart components with modern HTML5 code.
- With a colleague at Zereturnaround, I delivered two successful web projects using Java and the Play! web framework in three months!
- Graduated *cum laude* with my diploma thesis “Face Detection and Tracking Method Based on Neural Networks and Skin Color Segmentation”
- Co-organized and given more than ten talks at local developer community meetups ([Devclub](#))

Work Experience briefly

- Atlassian - **TypeScript, NodeJS, React, Micro services, Angular** - *11 year*
- Toggl — **CoffeeScript, Backbone, Grunt** — *1.5 year*
- Zereturnaround — **Java, JavaScript, Python** — *1 year*
- 300.mg — **Ruby, CoffeeScript** — *freelance*
- Swedbank — **Java, JavaScript** — *2 years*
- Matvil Corporation — **Python, Django, Solr** — *freelance*
- Tallink — **Java, JavaScript** — *1 year*
- Mozilla Corp. — **Python, JavaScript** — *3 months (remotely)*
- SQA Partners — **Java, JavaScript** — *~ 4 years*

Work Experience in more details

08/2014 — Date.now() Full-stack engineer @ Atlassian

Stack parts: TypeScript, React, NodeJS, Java, Micro services, Angular

It's been 11 years of projects and work done. The following is some of the latest examples between FY24–FY25

Staff-level IC (P50) on the Linking Platform team within Atlassian's Teamwork Platform group, frequently acting as Tech Lead. Work spanned Confluence, Jira, Smart Links, Automations, and internal graph services.

1. Smart Link List View — Core Product Delivery

Led the development and delivery of Smart Link List View (SLLV), a feature that lets users embed live, configurable tables of Jira issues and other data directly inside Confluence and Jira editors — replacing the legacy Jira Issue Macro. Over the course of roughly a year, I built key UX capabilities including resizable columns, column wrapping, a sticky column picker, and a frontend caching layer. I also solved a critical performance bottleneck affecting instances with thousands of columns and drove scope tradeoffs to ensure the team shipped meaningful filtering without building throwaway code ahead of a planned platform change.

2. Architecture Decisions — Two-Way Sync & Datasource Strategy

Served as the primary technical voice on two major architectural questions. For Jira Two-Way Sync — which enables inline editing of Jira fields from within Confluence — I guided the Feature Lead through multiple milestones, identified a permissions design flaw early that prompted a full architecture change (preventing costly delays later), and made key data-structure decisions that saved time and produced a more future-proof solution. Separately, when Confluence launched its own “Database” feature and there was pressure to merge the two table implementations, I led a multi-week technical investigation, built a compelling case that the products had more differences than similarities, and successfully drove the decision to keep them separate — preventing a costly and confusing merge.

3. Teamwork Context — Graph-Based Collaboration

Led a team of four engineers over six weeks to build the backend and frontend foundation for Teamwork Context, an initiative that gives Atlassian products a shared understanding of how people, projects, and content relate. I owned the backend work — learning Cypher graph queries and integrating with Atlassian's Unified Graph Service — while also advocating for UX changes that simplified the implementation. By carefully sequencing work to minimise cross-engineer dependencies, the team had a working prototype with real data running in the product within two weeks.

4. Technical Leadership

Served as Acting Tech Lead for extended periods, managing a team of 5–8 engineers across sprint planning, grooming, weekly 1:1s, and stakeholder communication. I was the go-to decision-maker for unblocking work and the primary bridge between engineering, product, and design. I improved team processes — moving estimation into grooming to eliminate redundant meetings, introducing pre-grooming prep sessions, and championing recorded walkthroughs for complex PRs. As a member of the Technical Advisory Group,

I led investigations into feature-flagging migration impact and authored a strategy to reduce on-call noise from third-party service alerts, which was adopted across the platform.

5. Cross-Product Declarative UI

Under a tight six-week deadline (with only 3–4 weeks available before leave), I designed and delivered a declarative UI framework for Atlassian's Automations product. The system dynamically renders input fields based on the selected action type, and the resulting schema became a shared foundation that allowed both Rovo (Atlassian's AI product) and Automations to reuse the same actions with different presentations.

6. Developer Tools & Internal Products

Built and maintained several widely-used internal tools. I created a graph schema visualisation tool for the Unified Graph Service from scratch — after the PM deprioritised it — replacing a previous tool that took 3+ minutes to load; it was adopted company-wide. I am the sole maintainer of Better Retros, a Confluence plugin for running retrospectives used to create thousands of retros per quarter, keeping it operational through outages, AWS region migrations, and compliance requirements. I also built and maintain a timesheet-filling script used by thousands of employees that.

7. Cross-Team Negotiations & Ownership Transitions

Repeatedly represented the team in high-stakes cross-team discussions. I negotiated an API decommission timeline with an internal platform team, pushing back the deadline and choosing a long-term migration path that freed team resources. I drove two major ownership transitions — the Editor/Smart Links component handover (documenting all link-related code, running meetings with principal-level engineers, and transferring code ownership) and a Confluence-specific service transition (authoring architecture diagrams and handover documentation). I also redirected an internal product team toward a simpler integration approach that saved them an estimated six weeks of development, and pushed back on leadership's proposal to remove a feature by presenting usage data and an alternative solution, which I then implemented.

8. Mentorship & People Development

Contributed to the promotion of three team members by intentionally distributing impactful projects, tailoring work to individual growth goals, and providing consistent 1:1 guidance. I started an engineering book club around Clean Architecture that ran weekly for months, mentored a junior engineer through a formal mentorship programme, and onboarded a new PM as de facto tech lead. My approach was hands-on — one mentoring relationship involved over 1,000 Slack messages in a single half-year alongside weekly sessions.

9. Engineering Craft & Operational Excellence

Maintained a high engineering bar through extensive PR reviews (~60 in a single half in the main frontend monorepo alone), consistently pushing for test coverage, clean code, and preventing accidental breaking changes. On the technical side, I unblocked the company-wide React 18 migration by finding and fixing the only blocking bug in our codebase (a subtle `useEffect` behaviour difference), demonstrated advanced TypeScript expertise, and resolved complex backend bugs under SLO pressure — including late-

night fixes for customer-reported issues. I also led incident response across teams, identifying root causes (such as a feature flag from another team breaking embeds in staging) and escalating systemic issues like a failing deployment pipeline.

10. Organisational & Cultural Impact

Ran fortnightly demo sessions for the broader platform group and facilitated regular knowledge-sharing presentations, helped organise team offsites and social events, conducted frontend interviews throughout the period while teaching colleagues the interview process, and maintained community gatherings for local Atlassian employees.

03/2013 — 08/2014 Front-end engineer @ Toggl

Technologies: Backbone, CoffeeScript, Grunt, Scss, WebSockets, Offline work, Local storage, Thick client with REST API backend

As part of the Toggl development team, I developed a completely new web experience for our user base of more than 500,000. This is a complete static client-side application that uses REST API on the backend. I modularized our client-side Backbone code in order to increase maintainability and facilitate its reuse. It uses websockets for instantaneous synchronisation and can also work offline. It's live right now and accessible on <http://new.toggl.com>. [Screenshots](#)

I wrote the web application for Toggl's hiring campaign as a personal initiative. Every applicant can test his or her knowledge and show their coding skills. [Screenshots](#) I released this code as an [open source](#) project.

I initiated and pushed through an idea of writing a new mobile app using native technologies (the old one was unpretty mobile website wrapped with Cordova). Later I was in the team who created initial [beta version](#).

03/2012 - 03/2013 — Software Engineer for Web @ Zereturnaround

Positions: Software engineer / Web developer for supporting existing web projects and participating in creating new ones

Technologies: Java, JavaScript, Python, CoffeeScript, Node.js, Play!, Play! 2

With a colleague at Zereturnaround, I delivered two successful web projects ([myJRebel](#) and [License Server 2.0](#)) using Java and the Play! web framework in three months! [Screenshots](#)

During another project, I implemented Acceptance / UI tests for company main website using Python. The main goal of this project was to keep the integrity of the website crucial parts.

05/2010 - 03/2012 — Front-end Java Software Engineer @ Swedbank

Position: Software engineer in the IT department of "Large corporates & Institutions" (Java + JS)

Responsibilities: * New business requirements development in all applications related to the stock market (including Internet Bank, and administrative application for tellers). * Maintenance of current code base

Technologies: Java, XSLT transformations, JavaScript, Oracle

Experience gained: * Working in a large corporation (~ 17,220 emp.) with a huge code base and many interconnected applications * Estonian language practice.

04/2010 - 11/2010 — Python Web Developer (remote) @ Matvil Corporation

Position 1: Full-text search engine configuration (Python + Solr)

Development of a backend (Python + Django) and front-end (for the search functionality on etvnet.com) Configuration of a full-text search engine (Solr) for an existed database

Position 2: Django development + integration with third party's e-book content provider.

- Development of the new E-books catalogue site (From top to the bottom)
- Development of the batch process for integration with an E-book provider via REST API (Python).

Experience gained: Development with Django framework, Full-text search engine configuration, Git, Working remotely

04/2009 - 05/2010 - Front-end Java Web Developer @ AS Tallink Group IT

Position: Java Web Developer - Front-end and server-side (Java)

- I developed and maintained existing ExtJS application and existing booking application
- Being part of the team I helped develop a new Web app for on-line tickets booking. It included both: server-side driven by the Spring framework, as well as front-end made mostly with jQuery javascript framework.

06/2009 - 08/2009 - Contractor on experimental project @ Mozilla Corporation

I was working on an experimental module of Bepin project, which would parse PSD (Photoshop) file and produce web components (html+css). One the main results of this work were Python library, that could parse PSD.

10/2003 - 04/2009 - Java Web Developer @ SQA Partners

This was my first programming experience, my Alma mater as I think about it. Mainly I was responsible for Web UI of all web-projects. During two last projects, which were Web Applications (Java, Struts, iBatis/Hibernate, Oracle) I wrote front-end controllers and a service layer's business logic.

Education

2008 - 2011 Bachelor of Applied Sciences (in Informatics) from Estonian Entrepreneurship University

Graduation *cum laude*. Diploma thesis was “Face detection and tracking method, based on neural networks and skin colour segmentation.” [summary](#)

Online courses: * Introduction to Artificial Intelligence (by Peter Norvig and Sebastian Thrun) - 83.6% [sertificate](#) * Programming a Robotic Car (by Sebastian Thrun) - (With Highest Distinction) [sertificate](#) * HTML5 Game Development [sertificate](#)

Courses in Tallinn Technical University: * Advanced algorithms and data structures * Data mining * Functional programming

References Available upon request.